Joel Leiva

Elizabeth, NJ • leivajo@kean.edu • 908-414-6885 • LinkedIn • GitHub

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am writing to express my interest in the cybersecurity internship position. I am a Computer Science student at Kean University specializing in Cybersecurity and currently work as a Junior Security Operations (SecOps) Analyst with Kean University Information Technology. In this role, I monitor enterprise security events through a SIEM platform, triage alerts, investigate security cases, and collaborate with Networking, Cloud Engineering, and IT Security teams to identify threats and strengthen enterprise security operations.

A key part of my role is improving the efficiency of Security Operations. I develop automation scripts to streamline repetitive security workflows and reduce manual effort for analysts. I also designed and built an internal AI-assisted knowledge platform to help onboard future Security Operations analysts by providing guidance on alert triage, investigation workflows, and standard operating procedures. Through this experience, I have developed a strong understanding of security monitoring, incident analysis, operational processes, and cross-functional collaboration within an enterprise environment supporting more than 20,000 students and staff.

In addition to my SecOps role, I work as a Threat Intelligence Analyst Intern with Kean University's Center for Cybersecurity, where I conduct OSINT research on ransomware, data breaches, DDoS attacks, and emerging threats affecting nonprofit and NGO organizations. This experience has strengthened my ability to analyze attacker activity and translate technical findings into actionable defensive insights.

I have also developed hands-on infrastructure and security experience through the NCyTE Virtual Cybersecurity Career Challenge, where I worked in a Proxmox-hosted enterprise environment with routers, firewalls, Active Directory/DNS, database, web and email servers, and client endpoints. I configured firewall policies, implemented LAN/WAN/DMZ segmentation, and hardened Windows and Linux systems. I continue developing these skills through my home lab while pursuing the CompTIA Security+ and Cisco CCNA certifications.

I am excited about the opportunity to bring my professional Security Operations experience, technical background, and commitment to continuous improvement to your organization. I welcome the opportunity to discuss how my experience in security monitoring, investigation, automation, and defensive security can contribute to your team.

Sincerely,

Joel Leiva